

Determining the effects of Information Technology on Impulsive Buying Behaviour in the Online Food Industry of Pakistan with Focus on Social Media Marketing

STUDENT NAME:

ANIL EMANUEL

SRN:

120472266

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

Information technology has revised how humans conduct their normal routine business. The automated tools have provided us new definitions of efficiency. With advent of Internet, our perception of daily routine has changed quite significantly. Explicitly social media has made significant impacts on the consumers' minds over the past few years. People's thinking patterns have been totally altered due to posted content on social media pages (shaheen & lodhi 2016). Social media has become one of the leading domains of information technology for raising awareness and has served as an effective marketing tool. Companies extensively use social media marketing for the advertisement and promotions of their products and services. Studies notify that information technology tools have had a significant impact on how we perceive life. Social media marketing influences on consumer behaviours and it remains significant to determine the impact level of online impulsive buying behaviours in different industries (Akhtar, et al., 2015). Social media marketing campaigns have been executed extensively by the online food industry operating in Pakistan. Since the trend of online food purchasing trend in Pakistan is relatively new, therefore it is anticipated that social media marketing gives a boost to the respective industry (Zafeer, 2016).

Social media marketing campaigns provide a clear-cut path about the orientation of the firms too. The promotions, offers and discounts get a viral impact instantly by using these forums. Companies hence tend to dedicate social media teams for these tasks (Khan, et al., 2016) The overall online impulsive buying behaviours arena of the consumers is based on several things in which social media marketing has a considerable effect too. However, in terms of Pakistani online food industry, it remains eminent to investigate the proportion to which social media marketing has been able to influence on the online impulsive buying behaviours. In this regard, the current study would be focused to measure the respective development.

1.2 Contextual Analysis

The online food sector of Pakistan is progressing by leaps and bounds over the years. The inclination of people towards social media marketing is on the rise and it remains significant to measure its effects in the Pakistani markets. The growth of online purchase mechanics is significant over the years as the online food industry has been providing convenient cash on delivery & credit card/debit card options for the Pakistani customers (Tech Juice, 2015). These sorts of endeavours along with proactive social media marketing have turned the tables over (Kaur and Kaur, 2015). The purchase behaviours of the people are on the rise and it is therefore necessary to investigate the magnitude of social media marketing on the overall online impulsive buying behaviours (Barnoya & Nestle, 2016).

1.3 Research Questions

The research questions of the respective study are:

Q.1 What are the impacts of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours?

Q.2 How viral marketing moderates among social media marketing and online impulsive buying behaviours?

Q.3 How does social media marketing influence on the online impulsive buying behaviours in the online food industry of Pakistan?

1.4 Significance of the Study

This study will be significant for the researchers, marketers and entrepreneurs. The marketers and managers would attain advantage through the outcomes of this study that in what ways social media marketing influences on the online impulsive buying behaviours. It is necessary to understand that social media marketing has a propensity of negative viral marketing too; therefore, considering all these elements is necessary. The spread of electronic word of mouth on the social media forums is frequent; hence marketers and managers would understand that how effectively their message can get spread on the online portals.

The researchers will get substantial benefit from this study as they would get to know the prevailing trends in the social media marketing and will also understand the online impulsive

buying behaviours in a different manner. The study will give concrete advantages to the entrepreneurs too that how social media marketing works in the emerging markets. Pakistani online food industry is getting elevation at a rapid pace and it is anticipated that social media marketing has been one of the major influencers in this entire paradigm. It is therefore important to measure holistic social media marketing effects in the online food industry of Pakistan.

1.5 Research Limitations

There are certain limitations of this study which must be considered before generalization. The study will be conducted in the online food industry of Pakistan only. Survey method using structured questionnaire are used for the collection of primary data. The respondents' data are attained from the Pakistani consumer markets only. The study will be cross-sectional since it will be conducted in one go due to time constraint. The composite and dimensional impacts of social media marketing will be examined; however due to time constraint, no mediation effects are measured.

1.6 Plan of the Project

The study is divided into seven chapters and each chapter will elaborate the research process in a distinctive manner.

Chapter 1 will provide introduction to the study. The research title, background, study context, research questions, scope and significance will be discussed in this chapter.

Chapter 2 will be of literature review in which literary foundations of the variables will be discussed. Thorough discussion on social media marketing and online impulsive buying behaviours will be conducted in this chapter.

Chapter 3 will present objectives and research method. Survey approach will be taken for this study and the chapter will elucidate why survey method is used, its benefits and the entire primary research basis will be exemplified too.

Chapter 4 will present the conceptual framework of the study. Conceptual framework is the heart of any research study and the entire research is based on it. The framework is designed according to the guidelines provided in the literature review section.

Chapter 5 will present findings of the study. Statistical modelling will be applied on the primary data and hence results attained will be provided in this section.

Chapter 6 will be of analysis in which results will be matched with the conceptual framework; hence theoretical foundations established would be analysed.

Chapter 7 will conclude the research study and it will provide summary of the project and directions for future research.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

This section illustrates the literary foundations that led to the execution of this study.

2.1 Social Media Marketing

The entire field of marketing is very specific and very broad in nature. It helps a company to grow positively in the market. In this particular aspect, companies have to work extremely hard in the long run. The factor of marketing is essential as it helps the company to make their products marketed easily and efficiently. There are numerous factors and divisions that can be found interactive in the field of marketing, and among them the name of Social Media Marketing is one of them (Ahmed 2016).

According to (Awan et al. 2015), Social Media Marketing is one of the newest concepts that underlie in the market of the organization to make and deliver something efficient for the companies. In other words, social media marketing has brought totally a new revolution in the Marketing Industry. With the providence of low cost marketing factor, this particular strategy also helps a company to focus on a larger perspective as compared to any other form of marketing. In highly efficient and organized markets, the factor of social media marketing is very common and very efficient as well. However, the utilization of the social media marketing is increasing equally in the Third World Countries of the world as well such as Pakistan (Baloch & Mir 2014). Pakistan is now dragging itself in the major growing economies of the world, therefore more and more of its population are now moving towards the technological efficiency and effectiveness. Social Media Marketing is playing a very positive and efficient role in the changing the purchasing behaviour of Pakistani consumers related to Online Foods.

Comparison is Possible: According to (Baloch & Mir 2014), one of the most efficient and important thing that associated with the purchasing behaviour of the consumers is comparison. It means that consumers always like to compare the companies which are relating to each other before taking and making their decisions. The same is applicable in the context of the Food Processing companies as well. Social Media Marketing in Pakistan provides opportunity to the consumers through which they can compare the online food providers and their foods before making a purchasing decision (Barnoya & Nestle 2016).

This particular factor deems highly efficient and abbreviated from the viewpoint of the Online Food Companies in Pakistan.

Pricing Factor: In the light of (Barnoya & Nestle 2016), Online products are comparatively cheaper than Offline Products, because the companies might not include the marketing and research cost in their product, which helps them to approach to the general public in a more efficient and organized manner. The same factor is very special and essential for the Online Food Industry of Pakistan, which is growing very rapidly. The Food Sector is one of the top notch sectors in Pakistan that has a strong connection with the growing Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of the country. With the help of powerful tactic of Social Media Marketing, consumers can get an idea about the pricing of the products which they are likely to gain along with accessing to their favourite items in relatively lower amount (Bohari et al. 2013). This particular factor deems highly favourable for the company in the long run.

The Rating Factor: One of the most efficient aspects that associated with the efficiency and productivity of an organization is the rating factor. The best thing that found very efficient and interactive in the context of the Social Media Marketing is the rating factor (Dawn, 2017). Social Media Marketing allows the consumers to compare the underlying companies on the basis of their ratings, and then reach on a final verdict about their purchasing. The same is applicable with the Online Food Industry of Pakistan. The level of competition has increased tremendously well in the online food industry of Pakistan that allows the consumers to easily compare the quality and items of foods easily with other markets before taking their decisions in particular. This particular factor can increase the financial and strategic potential of the company in the long run as well.

In short, it can be said that social media marketing, likewise other organizations deem highly efficient and effective for the Food Companies as well, and its relationship is very essential and specific in the context of Pakistani Food Market as well, which is currently on the Growing stage of the Product Life Cycle (PLC).

2.2 Online Impulsive Buying Behavior

According to Food Panda (2017), customers are the most important individuals that associated with an organization. The satisfied the customers, the efficient would be attentiveness in the market. Consumers always like to consume the products that can fulfil their appetite in a professional manner, and doesn't provide higher burdensome to the pricing factor associated with them. It is essential for the organizations to retain their customers with

them for a long span of time, and sustain their position in the market. Likewise, other industries, the stance of satisfied customers are equally beneficial and efficient for the Food Industry of Pakistan as well (Hussain, Zulfiqar & Saboor 2014). The impulsive buying behaviour of the consumers affects over the companies through which they can get the access of different promotional factors use by the companies to increase the amount of the consumers towards their business. Currently, different online food companies in Pakistan are giving different promotional schemes to their end users which is essential for their presence and attendance for the companies.

Need Recognition: The first element that found interactive in the decision making process is Need Recognition. It means that the consumers are in need of complete recognition of the products of the market, and the company through which they can buy their products (Naqvi et al. 2013). The factor of recognition can be found completely and efficiently in the online food industry, and the same context is applied in the scenario of the Online Food Industry of Pakistan. Social Media Marketing is doing an exceptional job in terms of providing complete knowledge base related to the underlying factor that can satisfy the needs of the customers accordingly (Nestle 2013).

Search of Information: The second element that found interactive in the decision making process is Searching of relevant information. It means that the consumers are in need of complete information related to the products found in the market, through which they can buy their products (Nestle 2013). The factor of information searching can be found completely and efficiently in the online food industry, and the same context is applied in the scenario of the Online Food Industry of Pakistan. Social Media Marketing is doing an exceptional job in terms of providing complete information related to the underlying factor that can satisfy the needs of the customers accordingly (Nowak & Szewczyk 2015).

Analysis of the Alternatives: The third element that found interactive in the decision making process analysing the alternatives. It means that the consumers are in need of analysing about their alternatives before making the purchasing decision (Nowak & Szewczyk 2015). The factor of analysing the alternatives can be found completely and efficiently in the online food industry, and the same context is applied in the scenario of the Online Food Industry of Pakistan (Nestle 2013). Social Media Marketing is doing an exceptional job in terms of providing complete knowledge about different competitors in the market that can help the individuals to reach on the verdict of buying products.

Purchase Decision: The next element that found interactive in the decision making process is Purchase Decision. It is known as the second last factor that found in this particular model, in which the consumer will reach on the final point or verdict in terms of making a decision relating to the purchase. This particular factor can be found easily in the context of the social media marketing, especially in the Online Food companies in Pakistan to make the things efficient in their favour in particular (Nestle 2013).

Post Purchase Decision: The last element that found interactive in the decision making process is Post Purchase Decision. It is known as the last factor that found in this particular model, in which the consumer will reach on the final point or verdict in terms of making a decision relating to the purchase along with giving feedback about the purchase (Sabir et al. 2014). This particular factor can be found easily in the context of the social media marketing, especially in the Online Food companies in Pakistan to make the things efficient in their favour in particular.

2.3 Viral Marketing

There are numerous types of marketing that deems highly essential and favourable for the companies. As mentioned earlier that social media marketing is a broad term that stride under the umbrella of professional marketing deems highly favourable for the companies. There is a type of marketing that specifically stride under the umbrella of Social Media Marketing, known as Viral Marketing (Tech Juice. 2015).

According to (Watto & Mugeru 2015), any process that goes highly viral on the social networks that have the capacity to attract the attention of the consumers and the end users is known as Viral Marketing. Most of the individuals throughout the world are known very efficient in terms of having viral marketing (Naqvi et al. 2013). Viral Marketing can be very specific and positive in terms of increasing the sales and marketing provision of a company in a professional and ethical manner. Likewise, other companies across Pakistan and throughout the world the factor of viral marketing deem highly essential and effective (Webster et al. 2014). Viral Marketing is found equally effective and beneficial in the context of the Food Industry of Pakistan. There are numerous ways in which Viral Marketing is affecting the Online Food Industry in Pakistan. Some of the major elements found very efficient in the context of viral marketing are as follows

Comparison makes easy: In the light of the study of (Zafeer 2016), one of the most efficient and important thing that associated with the purchasing behaviour of the consumers is

comparison. It means that consumers always like to compare the companies which are relating to each other before taking and making their decisions (Naqvi et al. 2013). The same is applicable in the context of the Food Processing companies as well. Viral Marketing throughout the world related to foods gives the opportunity to the consumers through which they can compare the online food providers and their foods before making a purchasing decision. This particular factor deems highly efficient and abbreviated from the viewpoint of the Online Food Companies in Pakistan (Awan et al. 2015). There is a perfect example of FoodPanda.com, an online application of Food from where the consumers can compare the foods and their prices of different companies to reach on a final decision.

Cheaper and Expensive Factor: One of the most efficient and foremost advantages of the Viral Marketing is give a thorough idea to the consumers about the underlying products. It gives a thorough idea about the products which are comparing each other. The same factor is very special and essential for the Online Food Industry of Pakistan, which is growing very rapidly (Baloch & Mir 2014). The Food Sector is one of the top notch sectors in Pakistan that has a strong connection with the growing Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of the country. With the help of powerful tactic of Viral Marketing, consumers can get an idea about the pricing of the products which they are likely to gain along with accessing to their favourite items in relatively lower amount. This particular factor deems highly favourable for the company in the long run (Naqvi et al. 2013).

Capturing Mass Marketing with Rating: One of the most efficient aspects that associated with the efficiency and productivity of an organization is the factor of mass marketing and capturing. The best thing that found very efficient and interactive in the context of the Viral Marketing is the rating factor. Viral Marketing allows the consumers to compare the underlying companies on the basis of their ratings, and then reach on a final verdict about their purchasing (Baloch & 2014). Moreover, the comments related to the company allow the consumers to reach on the final verdict. The same is applicable with the Online Food Industry of Pakistan. The level of competition has increased tremendously well in the online food industry of Pakistan that allows the consumers to easily compare the quality and items of foods easily with other markets before taking their decisions in particular.

In short, it can be said that viral marketing, likewise are anticipated to be highly efficient and effective for the Food Companies as well, and its relationship is very essential and specific in

the context of Pakistani Food Market as well, which is currently on the Growing stage of the Product Life Cycle (PLC).

The Literature Gap

This particular literature review is likely to analyse the effect of the social media marketing over the providence of positive role in the online food purchasing behaviour in Pakistan. The importance of Social Media and its application have been analysed in different parts of the world, especially in the region of the United States (U.S) and the United Kingdom, where people are very fond of using the social media structuring factor. Pakistani market in terms of analysing the social media influence and infrastructure is quite new in the business; and it has been currently elevating the use of such mediums for the marketing of food products.

Problems are found in the capacity of the Pakistani market, due to dearth of knowledge and material associated with the same analysis that may affect over the working and accumulation of the data in particular. However, the researcher has worked so hard to accumulate the data of the Pakistani market, and mould it accordingly in the best possible effectiveness to collect the result in an efficient manner. It is also certain that the future researches would be more volatile and up to the market, because new researches are now starting to conduct under the same domain that will help the researcher to get the things in an efficient manner.

CHAPTER 3

OBJECTIVES AND RESEARCH METHODS

3.1 Introduction

The research methods part is conducted by keeping objectives of the study aligned. In order to investigate the causal relationship among the constructs, quantitative research was conducted. It is eminent to determine viral and social media marketing effects on the online impulse buying behaviour protocols. In the execution of any research study, the role of methodology to be used is critical. The research methodology part illustrates the credibility, reliability and validity of the research work. In the field of management and social sciences, research methodology alters the entire trail and path of a study. It is necessary to execute appropriate research technique in an empirical research study. The research methodologies mainly used in studies are qualitative research and quantitative research or both. The longitudinal studies mostly comprise of both qualitative and quantitative research work while research work with limited resources and time frame use either quantitative methods or qualitative methods. The research studies do not process any empirically tested study unless and until evidences of qualitative or quantitative research are not present in it. In order to confine the study in the assigned time frame, dimensional impact of the constructs was taken under consideration.

3.2 Research Objectives

The objectives of this study are very clear-cut and precise.

- To measure the impacts of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviour.
- To explore the effects of viral marketing among social media marketing and impulsive buying behaviours.
- To determine the effects of social media marketing on impulsive buying behaviours making in the online food industry of Pakistan.

These objectives can be achieved by using relevant research methods. In this regard, positivist research philosophy is used and quantitative research is conducted using questionnaire. Further illustration is provided in the respective chapter.

3.3 Quantitative Research Method

The quantitative research methods deal with numerical data and statistical analysis. The data collection, processing and analysis; the entire protocol is done in numerical figures. The attainment of data is the foremost aspect which is done using questionnaire mainly. Questionnaire is the supreme source of collecting quantitative data. The questionnaire has quantitative scales for analysis, e.g. Likert scale which has a set value. The determination of each answer is measured on the scale. Likert scale is commonly used in the questionnaire. The answers attained are then pasted on statistical analysis software e.g. SPSS, E-views, Microsoft Excel, LISREL, AMOS, PROLAC, STATA etc. The role of this software's is crucial as they process the entire data set. This research work has used SPSS as the statistical analysis tool.

The cleansing of data is vital and it is done in the first phase. The data brought up on the software is cleaned by using different techniques and methods. The eradication of missing fields and eliminating same answered responses is necessary in the research work (Venkatesh, et al., 2013). These all steps increase the credibility of a research study. The data cleansing part is done so that raw data would be purified and then processed for statistical analysis. Before the statistical analysis, validity and reliability determination of the data is mandatory (Harding & Norberg, 2014). These measures are taken for the betterment of research study. If the accumulation of unconstructive results materializes in the reliability and validity part; then there are no bases of conducting the research work. The study is terminated for further processing if the quantitative results do not satisfy the minimum benchmarks of quantitative figures.

The validity aspect is measured in construct validity, content validity and face validity. Content and face validity are non-numeric and they are judged by the research supervisors and responders respectively. However, construct validity is determined through Factor Loading Analysis and KMO and Bartlett's test. The factor loading analysis states that communalities and loadings of each question must not be less than 0.40 (principal axis rotation on varimax). KMO and Bartlett's value/test suggests that the value collectively appeared of all constructs must not be less than 0.70. These values are necessary to be satisfied in the validity part. The reliability of the data requires going through Reliability test. Cronbach's alpha value is examined in this phase. The value of Cronbach's alpha must not be less than 0.60.

After the validity and reliability part is satisfied, the study is good to go. Depending upon the nature, scope and orientation of the study, appropriate statistical tests are applied. For instance, in causal research study, regression and correlations are necessary to be inspected. Four assumptions of regression are necessary to be satisfied in the first phase. The assumptions are:

- i. Normality of the data
- ii. The data must be valid
- iii. Reliable data must be processed
- iv. No issues of low correlations or multi-collinearity must exist in the data

These all components are eminent to be satisfied in the first phase. Normality of the data is checked by determining if there is any outlier present in the data or not. Afterwards, validity and reliability is checked (KMO & Bartlett's test and Cronbach's alpha value) and correlations of the construct are examined. Low correlations suggest that value of constructs is below 0.30, which means there is no connection between the constructs. Meanwhile, if the correlations values are higher than 0.70 then it means multi-collinearity issues prevail in the data. The satisfaction of all these assumptions finally lead to regression or multiple regression analysis in which t-value, F-statistics, B and beta values, R square and R squared changed value is examined.

Research studies mostly consist of quantitative research methods as they're easily understood and comprehended. Furthermore, general acceptability of the results attained from quantitative research has more impact factor since the numbers speak for themselves. The quantitative research method is a traditional/ classical way of carrying research study in the fields of management and social sciences. Most of the researchers prefer to have this method in their research endeavours.

3.4 Research Design & Process

The study is causal in nature and empirical investigations are done. The following chart describes the entire research design and process:

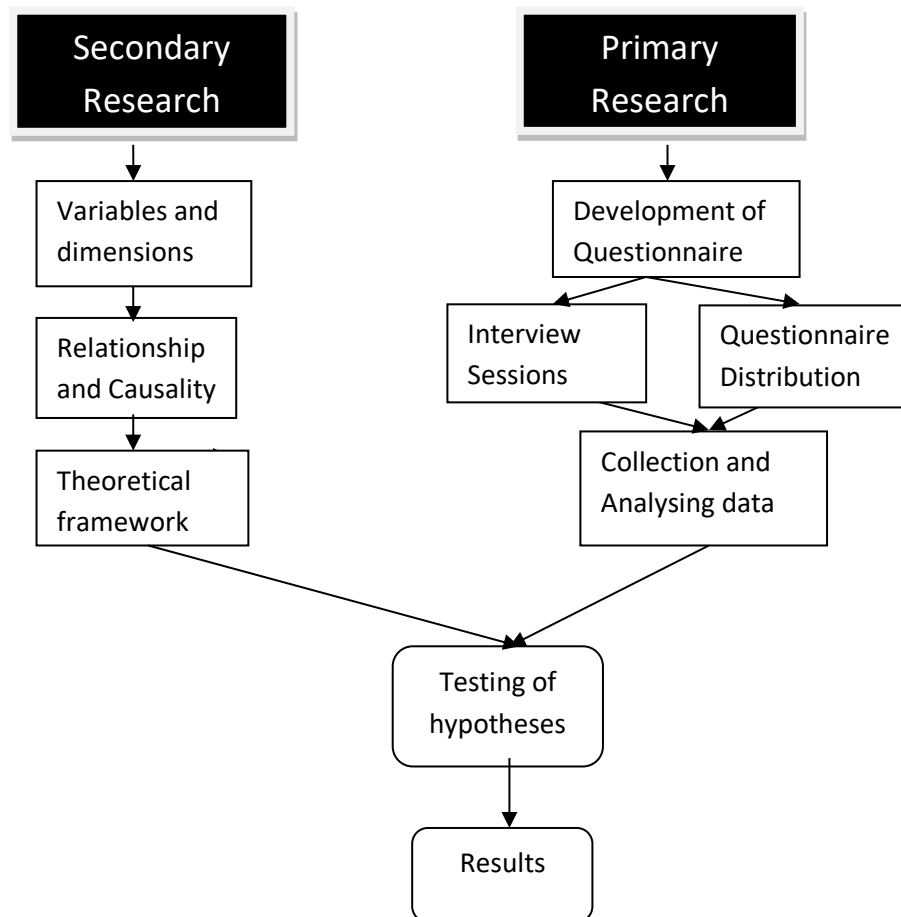


Figure 1: Research Process and Design

3.5 Research Instrument

Questionnaire was the instrument of the study. The questionnaire was comprised of closed ended questions regarding viral marketing, social media marketing and Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours the research instrument was adapted as the protocols of Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours, viral marketing and social media marketing needed to be scrutinized.

3.6 Research Tools

The research work would be quantitative in nature and statistical tests and tools have been applied to determine its causality. SPSS 20.0 edition is used for this study. Statistical tests of reliability, validity, correlation and regression have been applied.

3.7 Sampling Techniques

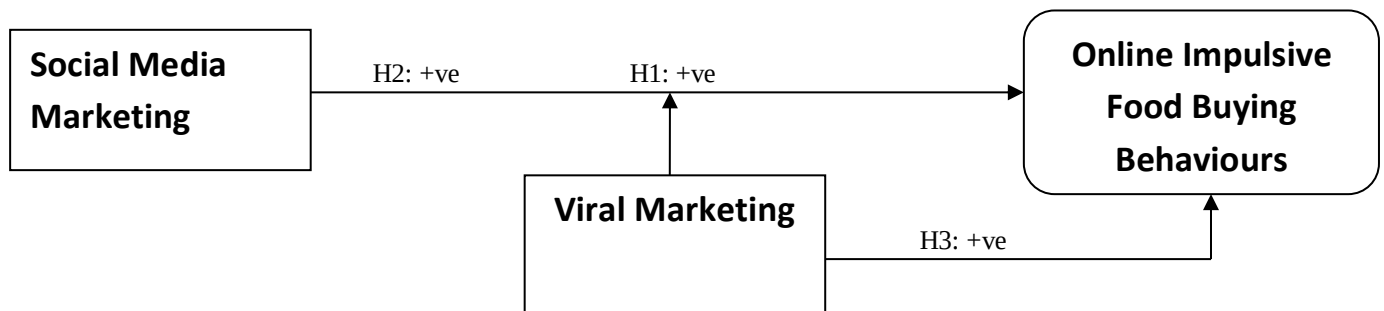
The sampling techniques differ in every research endeavour. There are two mainstream sampling techniques that are deployed in the research work; random sampling, non-random sampling. These both sampling techniques have further dimensions like cluster sampling, convenience sampling etc. Different online food consumers were identified on social media. 250 Confirmed individuals of Islamabad region were requested to fill out the questionnaire. The respondents were asked to fill out the questionnaire as per their convenience. A total of 187 individual responded back out of which 35 were either incomplete or incorrectly filled. In the end only 152 questionnaire were filled properly and useful for the research findings.

CHAPTER 4

CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

4.1 Conceptual Framework of the Study

The literary foundations have led to the construction of following conceptual/theoretical framework:



The research study is confined to determine the impacts of social media marketing on the impulsive buying behaviours. It is necessary to understand the horizon and impacts of social media marketing since it alters the entire course of action. People tend to order food online after checking out online posted ads. The online ads posted on the social media pages are very proactive and the reaction time towards them is relatively fast since impulsive buying tends to take place on a simple telephone call or online placement of order. The online ordering concept in the food industry is on the rise over the years and it is necessary to understand this entire paradigm significantly. Furthermore, it is important to note that social media remains a prominent tool in the online ordering mechanics as there are several promotions, discounts and sales offers.

The impulsive buying pattern tends to take place swiftly when the customers tend to see those ads online. The impacts of the social media marketing ads are immense and especially in the Pakistani consumer markets, the online trend is relatively new and unique; therefore, it remains necessary to cover and understand this entire phenomenon. The developmental endeavours taking place in the online context is necessary to grasp too since companies have been opting different means and mediums to pitch their respective target audiences. Online businesses have been opting different techniques and tactics in order to boost their respective

business endeavours. The workings conducted so far by them are phenomenal and it clearly gives an indication that an immense positive vibe in the online context has been created.

The viral marketing campaigns of the online food restaurants are necessary to be examined and gazed upon. The online marketing mix basically gives an indication and notion that the adverts of sales and promotions create a positive vibe in the online arena and it eventually mounts the impulsive buying behaviours of the people. It has been determined that there has been significant amount of working done by the marketing agencies too in order to create positive viral marketing of the food companies in the online context. The online proceedings done and carried out so far are quite appealing. This indicates the fact that viral marketing tends to have a positive impact on social media marketing and impulsive buying behaviours. The developed conceptual framework manifestly states the entire notion. Through the respective conceptual framework, following research hypothesis is developed.

4.2 Hypotheses:

H0: Social media marketing has no impact on online impulsive buying behaviours of consumers through negative viral marketing.

H1: Social media marketing has an impact on online impulsive buying behaviours through negative viral marketing.

H2: Social media marketing has a positive impact on online impulsive buying behaviours.

H3: Viral marketing of consumers has a positive impact on online impulsive buying behaviours.

CHAPTER 5

FINDINGS

5.1 Introduction

For the respective research study, different statistical tests were applied. The protocols of reliability and validity were satisfied in the first place. It is necessary to conduct validity and reliability of the data. For that purpose, validity and reliability norms were justified initially. Later conduction of correlations and simple linear regression models were applied. These all steps are necessary for the fulfilment of causal research work. This section illustrates results concluded from the data analysis module.

5.2 Demographics Statistics

The demographics results highlight the statistical outcomes of the overall attributes of the respondents from whom the data has been taken. The total number of respondents for this study was 152 in which 85 were male while 67 were females. Respondents' most dominant age group was 18-25 years. This age group had around 99 respondents which clearly illustrate that how much people from the respective cluster use social media marketing and how much of an impact they have on the online purchasing. The second most dominant age group was 26-32 years old in which 44 respondents were present. This age group clearly notifies that they had significant online purchase intentions too.

Table 5.1***Demographic Analysis***

		Frequency	Percentage	Valid Percentage	Cumulative Percentage
Gender	Male	85	55.9	55.9	55.9
	Female	67	44.1	44.1	100.0
	Total	152	100.0	100.0	
Age	18-25	99	65.1	65.1	65.1
	26-32	44	28.9	28.9	94.1
	33-39	5	3.3	3.3	97.4
	40-46	2	1.3	1.3	98.7
	47 and above	2	1.3	1.3	100.0

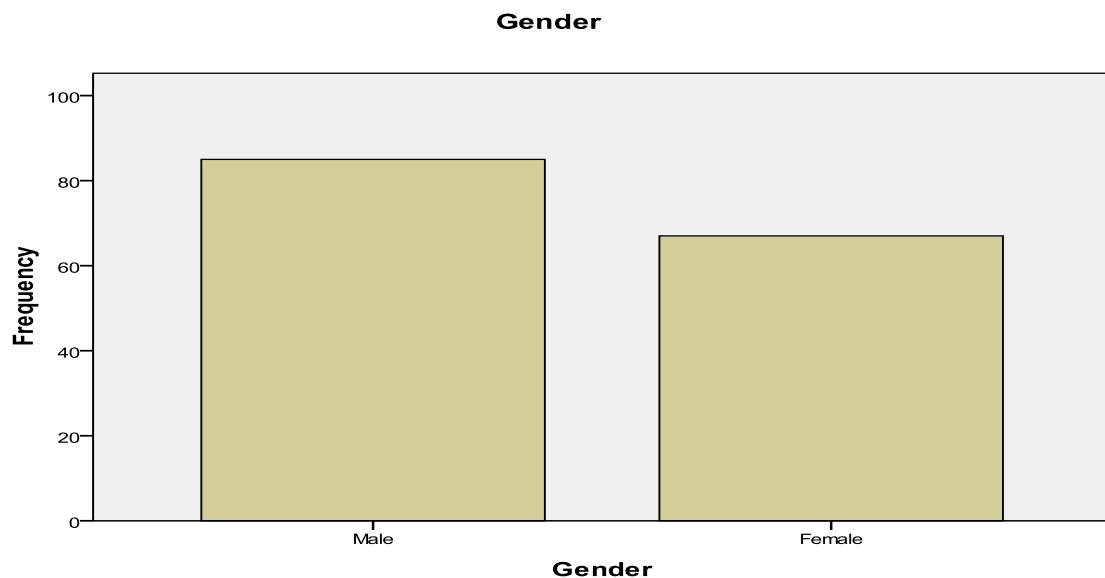


Figure 1: Gender Demographics

5.3 Descriptive Statistics

The descriptive statistics are conducted in order to check normality in the data. The attainment of normality in the data is necessary as outliers in the data set need to be eradicated. In order to examine the normality in the data, there are certain checks which must be understood. Since the questionnaire was designed on five Point-Likert scale, therefore the minimum and maximum values must be 1 and 5 respectively. Furthermore, the mean attained was greater than 2.50 which manifestly state that the data is normal. Standard deviation and variance results are less than one which is quite affirmative. Lastly, skewness values must be between 1 and -1 while kurtosis range is between 3 and -3. The results in the table below notify that normality in the data was attained as all the results were in their respective acceptance bracket.

Table 5.2***Descriptive Stats***

	N	Min	Max	Mean	Std. Devi	Vari	Skew		Kurt	
	Stat	Stat	Stat	Stat	Stat	Stat	Stat	Std. Err	Stat	Std. Err
SM	152	1.00	5.00	3.5974	.79067	.625	-.622	.197	.409	.391
VM	152	1.00	5.00	3.6645	.75528	.570	-.565	.197	.263	.391
OIBB	152	1.00	5.00	3.7911	.73941	.547	-1.044	.197	1.380	.391

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

5.4 Validity Analysis

The determination of validity is another important feature in the research work. Construct validity or questionnaire validity provides the basis that either questions asked from the respondents are valid or not. For this purpose, factor loading analyses are conducted. The determination of validity is the second assumption of regression and it is mandatory to determine construct validity after attaining normal data through descriptive statistics. Table 5.3, 5.4 and 5.5, provide validity results of all the research variables. The communalities values are all in the acceptance region while KMO and Bartlett's value is more than 0.60 and less than 1 which affirms that the questionnaire is valid and the responses are feasible to be analysed. The tables below manifestly illustrate validity results.

Table 5.3***Factor Loadings for the Rotated Factors Social Media Marketing***

Items	Factor loadings	
	1	Communality
SM1	.466	.498
SM2	.412	.466
SM3	.524	.644
SM4	.445	.494
SM5	.479	.513

Note: Loadings <.40 are excluded from the data.

Principal axis factor analysis were conducted on varimax rotation of the five items, that provided explained variance to be 52.29% while KMO and Bartlett's value was 0.815 which is in the acceptance range.

Table 5.4***Factor Loading for the Rotated Factors Viral Marketing***

Items	Factor loading	
	1	Communality
VM1	.423	.622
VM2	.380	.507
VM3	.203	.253
VM4	.311	.418

Note: Loadings < .40 are excluded from the data.

Principal axis factor analysis were conducted on varimax rotation of the four items, that provided explained variance to be 45.00% while KMO and Bartlett's value was 0.753 which is in the acceptance range.

Table 5.5***Factor Loading for the Rotated Factors Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours***

Items	Factor loading	
	1	Communality
OIBB1	.126	.152
OIBB2	.349	.454
OIBB3	.456	.621
OIBB4	.434	.596

Note: Loadings <.40 are excluded from the data.

Principal axis factor analysis were conducted on varimax rotation of the five items of online impulsive buying behaviours, that provided variance to be 45.57% while KMO and Bartlett's value was 0.737 which is in the acceptance range.

5.5 Reliability

The reliability analysis is conducted with an orientation to determine that either research questions are valid or not. The attainment of valid and precise research questionnaires and items is necessary for the conduction of research studies. In order to testify that either the research questions were reliable or not, Cronbach's alpha values are determined using reliability analysis. The reliability analysis provides precise set of information about the items alpha values. Saunders (2008) states that the Cronbach Alpha values must be greater than 0.70 and less than 1. After the conduction of reliability analysis of the respective research study, it was concluded that all the items were reliable and there were no issues and concerns in this entire data set. The factor social media had alpha values of 0.844; viral marketing had alpha value of 0.753 while online impulsive buying behaviours had alpha values of 0.734.

These results indicate that positive amount of alpha values have been attained and they are good to go for the respective research study. Table 6 highlights the results.

Table 5.6

Factor Wise Reliability Statistics

Factor	Cronbach Alpha	Items
SM	.844	5
VM	.753	4
OIBB	.734	4
Total	.904	13

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

5.6 Correlations

Correlations results are of sheer importance and significance as it highlights the creation of possible relationship among the constructs. It is necessary to understand that correlations value higher than 0.80 illustrate high correlations which is also known as multicollinearity.

This is an important paradigm and must be considered significantly during the research work. Furthermore, in case of correlations results less than 0.30, low correlations concerns emerge which notifies that there is possibly low relationship among the variables. From the results attained, it can be seen precisely that the correlations outcomes were quite precise and there were no high or low correlations concerns. Figures can be seen in table 8 below.

Table 5.7***Correlations***

		SM	VM	CDB
SM	Pearson Correlation	1	.640	.647
VM	Pearson Correlation	.751**	1	.665
OIBB	Pearson Correlation	.651**	.668**	1

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

5.7 Hypotheses Testing

In this research study, there was a single null hypothesis while three true hypotheses. It is mandatory to understand the conception of hypothesis testing as in order to just check the relationship among the variables, correlations analysis is more than enough but in order make things evident and clear-cut, simple linear regression and multiple regression models have been conducted. The conduction of simple linear and multiple regression models is necessary as it manifestly states the causality among the variables.

Table 5.8***Regression Analysis – Moderation Results***

Steps	IV	DV	R ²	F-Stat	B	Beta	T-value	Sig Value
1	SM	OIBB	0.424	110.306	0.609	0.651	10.503	0.00**
2	VM	OIBB	0.446	120.992	0.654	0.668	11.000	0.00**
3	SM*VM	OIBB	0.464	129.776	0.101	0.681	11.392	0.00**

** Significance level $p < 0.01$

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

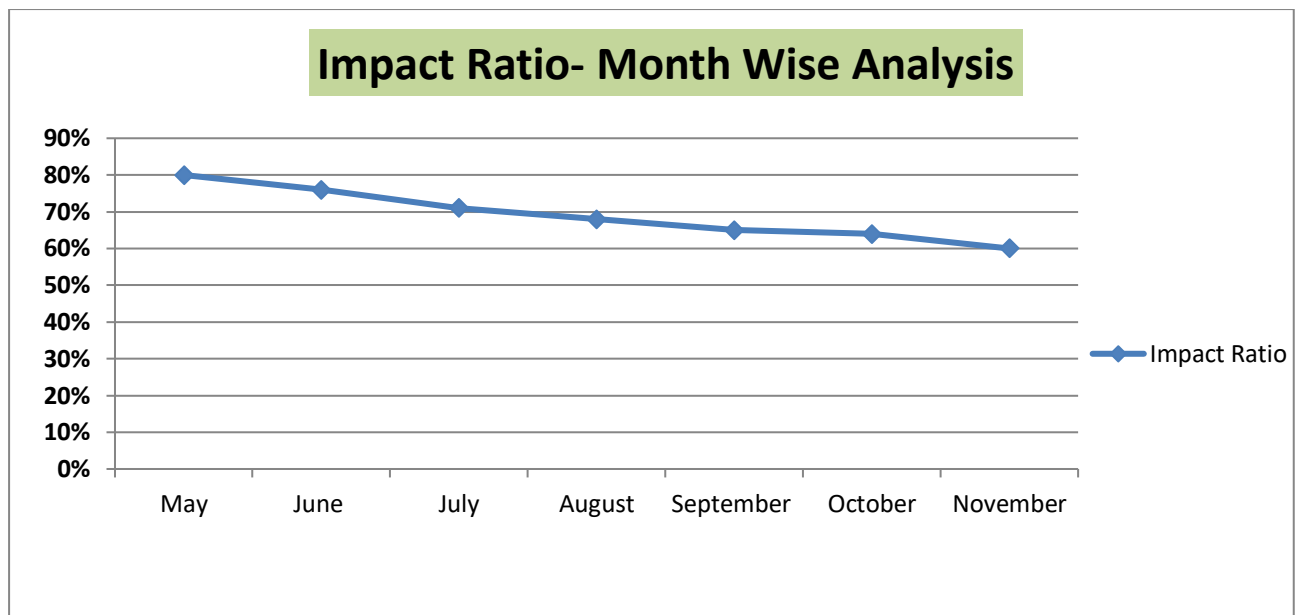


Figure 3: Hypothesis 2 Impact factor

Table 5.9: Simple Linear Regression Model – H2

Hypothesis	Un-Standard		Standard		Sig.
	B	Standard Error	Beta	t	
	1.601	.213		7.501	.000**
SM	.609	.058	.651	10.503	.000**

N = 152, R square = .484, F = 110.306, adjusted R square = .420; R = .651, (p < 0.01);

**Significance, p < .01

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

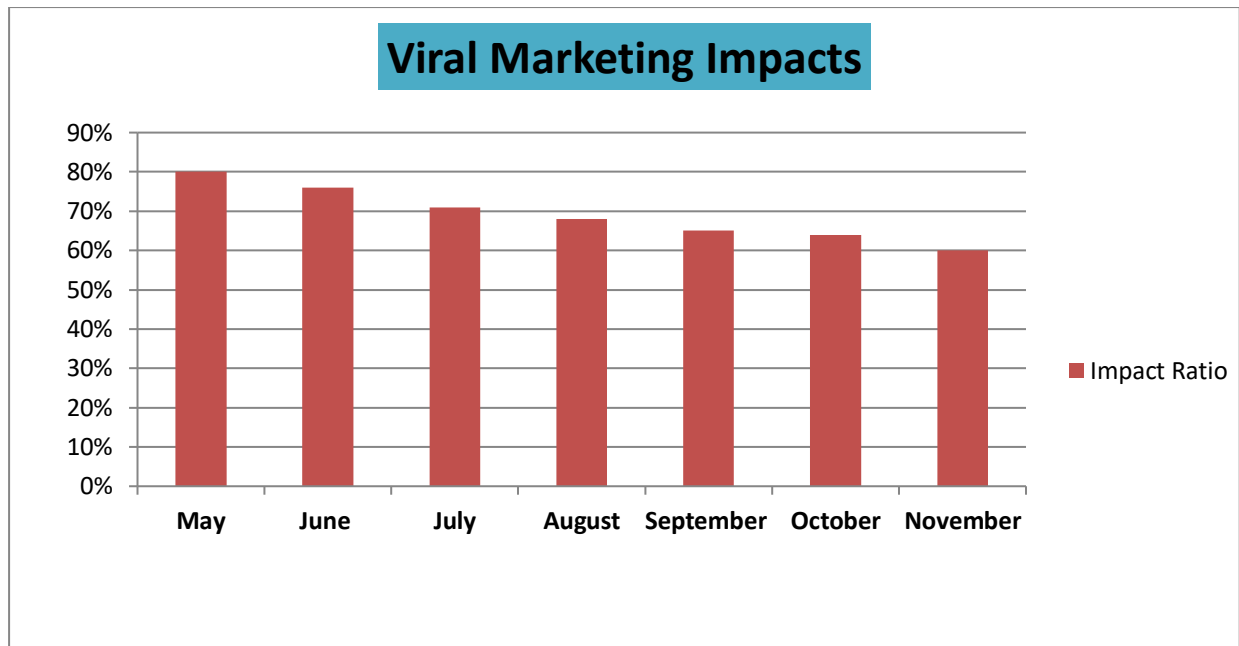


Figure 4: Viral marketing impacts of Online Restaurants

Table 5.10: Simple Linear Regression Model – H3

Hypothesis	Un-Standard		Standard		t	Sig.
	B	Standard Error	Beta			
	1.394	.222			6.266	.000**
VM	.654	.059	.668		11.000	.000**

N = 152, R square = .443, F = 120.992, adjusted R square = .448; R = .590, (p < 0.01);

**Significance, p < .01

*

SM: Social Media Marketing

VM: Viral Marketing

OIBB: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours

Table 5.11: Acceptance and Rejection of Hypotheses

Number of Hypotheses	Hypothesis Statement	Results
H₀	Social media marketing has no impact on online impulsive buying behaviours of consumers through viral marketing.	Rejected
H₁	Social media marketing has an impact on online impulsive buying behaviours through viral marketing.	Accepted
H₂	Social media marketing has a positive impact on online impulsive buying behaviours.	Accepted
H₃	Viral marketing of consumers has a positive impact on online impulsive buying behaviours.	Accepted

CHAPTER 6

ANALYSIS

The outcomes attained from the results section clearly notify about the acceptance of all the mainstream hypotheses of the research study. The role of social media marketing cannot be neglected or sidelined at any point of time. It is necessary to understand the paradigm of impulsive buying behaviours. The role of impulsive buying behaviours is immense as it creates hype and roar among the masses which leads to substantial sales and purchase behaviours of food online. It has been determined that the online food industry is on the boom and it will be progressing by leaps and bounds when effective social media marketing is conducted.

On the other hand, viral marketing effects cannot be sidelined as it provides the basis of creating significant amount of hype and roar among the masses. It is necessary to unfold this entire paradigm since social media marketing without the viral marketing effect has no substantial value and worth. Social media marketing has been altering online food purchase mechanisms among the masses.

The inspection of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours making along with moderation of viral marketing was done through multiple regression models. Simple linear regression is applied when individual effects are to be determined. As per Barron and Kenney method, moderation process cannot be executed unless simple regression among IV->DV and DV->MV is not satisfied. In case if there is no impact factor among the two constructs, multiple regression cannot be carried out. For this purpose, social media marketing impact was determined on viral marketing initially. The results turned out to be constructive as R square value was 0.424; F-statistics was quite strong with 110.30, B value 0.609, Beta 0.043 and T-value 10.503. It is to be noted that t-value presents the acceptance and rejection of hypothesis. As per the minimum benchmark, if t-value is less than 1.96 than the hypothesis is considered to be rejected.

Moreover, the B and Beta value must be less than 1. Significance value must be less than 0.5 and R square value should be greater than 0.3 so that causality among IV and DV would be notified. The second step was viral marketing effects inspection on online impulsive buying behaviours DV->MV. The results again supported the established notion as R square value

was 0.446, F statistics 120.992, B and Beta values to be 0.654 and 0.668 respectively. Meanwhile T-value was 11.000 and significance value 0.00 which is up to the mark.

The acceptance of these two hypotheses gave the green signal to examine moderation effect and execute multiple regression models. In this model IV get multiplied with MV and form a new variable. The newly created variable is then regressed with DV like a simple linear regression. The other method of carrying out multiple regression analysis is to insert both IV and MV in the independent variable section of SPSS and regress it with DV. The results attained manifestly embarked the acceptance of H1 that social media marketing has an impact on online impulsive buying behaviours of consumers through the moderation effect of viral marketing as the value of R square emerged to be 0.464 i.e. 46%. Secondly F-stats value was affirmative 129.776. Moreover, B and Beta values were less than 1 as it turned out to be 0.101 and 0.681 respectively. Lastly, significance value was 0.00 and T-value was 11.392, which highlights that the established hypothesis has been accepted.

The second hypothesis argued about social media impact on viral marketing and third hypothesis stated about viral marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours. The statistical results provided R, R^2 and Adjusted R^2 value indicated the acceptance of deduced hypotheses.

On the technical domain, the study only comprised of quantitative research analysis. The conduction of quantitative and qualitative research requires spending considerable time and resources. In case of achieving positive responses, the time and resources spend turn out to be fruitful. However, if negative outcomes materialize, then the study would be of no use and would be benefiting none. The use of quantitative data is generically more than qualitative data. The foremost reason behind this notion remains that mostly researchers follow this approach. The room of determining and examining causality is certainly more and biasness element is minimal in this approach. The quantitative research methods still after a decade of data analysis is considered to be most reliable and authentic. For example, acceptance or rejection of the hypothesis can be determined by watching t-value. If t-value is greater than 1.96, it means the hypothesis has been accepted. Meanwhile, if t-value is less than 1.96, it means hypothesis has been rejected.

In the qualitative research work, there are sheer chances of data manipulations and reporting as per the thinking of the researcher. Sometimes it is even difficult to comprehend the responses of the respondents. The emergence of diplomatic and unclear statement creates

problematic scenario for the research and he/she then reports data as per the approach. Coding method is also not considered very reliable since the choice of words and way of responding is different of all respondents and it becomes difficult for the data analysts to comprehend information gathered properly.

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION

7.1 Summary of the Assessment

In the respective study, the determination of social media marketing effects on impulsive buying behaviours by the moderation of viral marketing was determined in the online food industry of Pakistan. The research study provided substantial results as it changed the entire course of thinking. The online food purchase patterns are on the rise as most of the people are ordering food online. The boost in online food purchasing mechanisms clearly gives an indication that the food business is on the rise in the Pakistani consumer market and the beneficiaries are both multinational and local online food chains. The amount of online purchasing is escalated significantly and it gives a good positive indication about the respective industry.

Some further lines of activities that can be seen and anticipated that the role of Uber and Careem service in the Pakistani food arena. In the international markets of USA, Australia and Europe, Uber has introduced 'Uber Eats' services in which riders' deliver the online ordered food. This concept is on the rise in the global markets and it would be interesting to see when and how this service gets launched in the Pakistani consumer markets as it is an online unique trend of food purchasing and eventually a liaison of online food processing through Uber Eats would be an interesting mechanism to gaze upon. Due to time constraints, an illustrious picture of social media marketing was not taken in which online and offline food market dynamics were to be determined but for the future research studies, it is recommended that a comparative study of online and offline food purchase impulsive buying paradigm is explored.

7.2 Own Assessment

In order to complete the tasks in a more vibrant and proficient manner, I used SMART objectives for the management of tasks. SMART comprises of specific, measurable, attainable, realistic and time bound. The basic idea and theme remained that goals set are specific and that was completion of this project on-time and by fulfilling all the requirements of the university. In this phase, literature review section was done thoroughly in which all the possible literary foundations were highlighted, explored and noted down. In the next phase, questionnaire was developed and floated among the masses.

The data attained was then processed on SPSS for the statistical analysis purposes. The focus remained that all the formalities and concerns were fulfilled. Lastly, from the results attained discussion and conclusion section were duly done. The secondary and primary data collection part is quite difficult as substantial amount of readings have to be done and for questionnaire data attainment, identification of relevant target market and then requesting them to fill out the online survey form is a hectic task. The research work has created my interest in research studies and given me an inspiration and hope to opt for Masters by Research degree. The understanding of literature gave me an insight that how much role literature has in the construction of research framework and how outcomes of the study are achieved using different viable means and measures. SPSS analysis gave me a hope and inspiration that the collected data gives meaningful result through which research study can be validated.

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Appendix 1:**Topic Area Proposal**

Topic Area Proposal	
<u>Author:</u>	<u>Date and Revision:</u>
Anil Emanuel	28-April-2017
<u>Working Title:</u>	
Determining the effects of information technology on Impulsive Buying Behaviour in the Online Food Industry of Pakistan with focus on social media marketing	
<u>Main Theme:</u>	
The main theme of the study is that it is eminent to investigate the proportion to which social media marketing has been able to influence on the impulsive buying behaviours in the online food sector of Pakistan.	
<u>Research Questions</u>	
Q.1 What are the impacts of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours?	
Q.2 How viral marketing moderates among social media marketing and online impulsive buying behaviours?	
Q.3 How does social media marketing influence on the online impulsive buying behaviours in the online food industry of Pakistan?	
<u>Outline Main Argument</u>	
In this study I will measure the effects of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours in the online food sector of Pakistan.	
<u>Links to wider Information Systems Issues</u>	
The research links to the wider information systems issues like Information Security, Digital Marketing and Negative electronic word of mouth.	

Links to syllabus of other courses with in the degree

Management and innovation of E-Business

Information and communication technologies

Information systems development and management

5 Key words of phrases

Social Media. Viral Marketing. Online impulsive buying behaviours. Consumer Behaviours. Information Systems.

Alternative ways to research the topic and to collect data.

The respective study is done using quantitative research in which structured questionnaires were used however alternatively; qualitative research can be done using interviews.

Research Framework or Theory

The underpinning theory of this study was social exchange theory. Basically the transaction mechanisms among the customers and online food giants matters the most and it remains eminent to measure those using social exchange theory.

Required resources and issues of access:

The required sources were online data sources which include journals, articles, newspapers, magazines and books. Meanwhile for primary sources, questionnaire was being circulated among the respondents.

Assessment of required skills or techniques to be applied:

The need of good data analysis skills is required in which statistical analysis conduction is necessary in all regards. Furthermore, literature data review and analysis is also mandatory.

References to 5 articles or books relevant to the topic

Baloch, F., & Mir, A., (2014), Food portal: Breaking stereotypes, one meal at a time, *Express Tribune*, as accessed on 05 December 2016, <https://tribune.com.pk/story/792101/food-portal-breaking-stereotypes-one-meal-at-a-time/>

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Bohari, A. M., Cheng, W. H., & Fuad, N. (2013). An analysis on the competitiveness of halal food industry in Malaysia: an approach of SWOT and ICT strategy. *Geografia: Malaysian Journal of Society and Space*, 9(1), 1-11

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Hussain, A., Zulfiqar, F., & Saboor, A. (2014). Changing food patterns across the seasons in rural Pakistan: Analysis of food variety, dietary diversity and calorie intake. *Ecology of food and nutrition*, 53(2), 119-141

Webster, J., Trieu, K., Dunford, E., & Hawkes, C. (2014). Target salt 2025: a global overview of national programs to encourage the food industry to reduce salt in foods. *Nutrients*, 6(8), 3274-3287

Justification of interest to others

This study will be significant for the researchers, marketers and entrepreneurs. The marketers and managers would attain advantage through the outcomes of this study that in what ways social media marketing influences on the consumer decision making process. It is necessary to understand that social media marketing has a propensity of negative viral marketing too; therefore, considering all these elements is necessary. The spread of electronic word of mouth on the social media forums is frequent; hence marketers and managers would understand that how effectively their message can get spread on the online portals

Appendix 2

Project Specification

The project specification part is illustrated as follows:

1. Project Title

Determining the effects of Social Media Marketing on Impulsive Buying Behaviours in the Online Food Industry of Pakistan

2. Research Questions

Q.1 What are the impacts of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours?

Q.2 How does social media marketing influence on the online impulsive buying behaviours in the online food industry of Pakistan?

3. Research Objectives

- To measure the impacts of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviour.
- To explore the effects of viral marketing among social media marketing and online impulsive buying behaviours.
- To determine the effects of social media marketing on online impulsive buying behaviours making in the online food industry of Pakistan.

In order to measure these objectives, structured questionnaire was used as the survey technique and the data was collected online. The online data was processed and examined on SPSS where statistical tools and techniques were used.

SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE

GENDER: ☐ MALE ☐ FEMALE

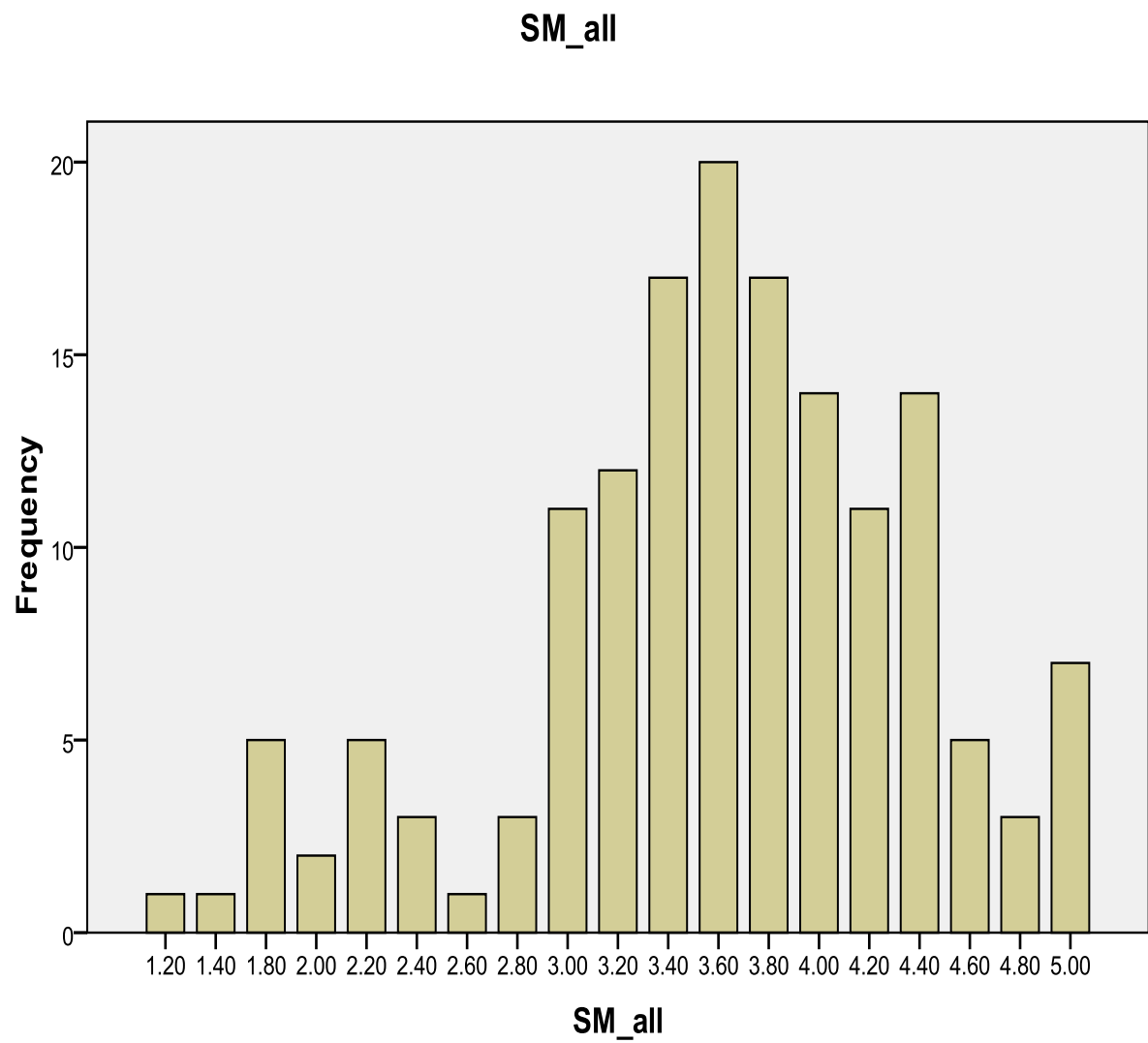
AGE: ☐ 18-25 ☐ 26-32 ☐ 33-39 ☐ 40-46 ☐ 47+

Please complete the following questionnaire with specific regard to the above, by placing a CROSS in the appropriate box

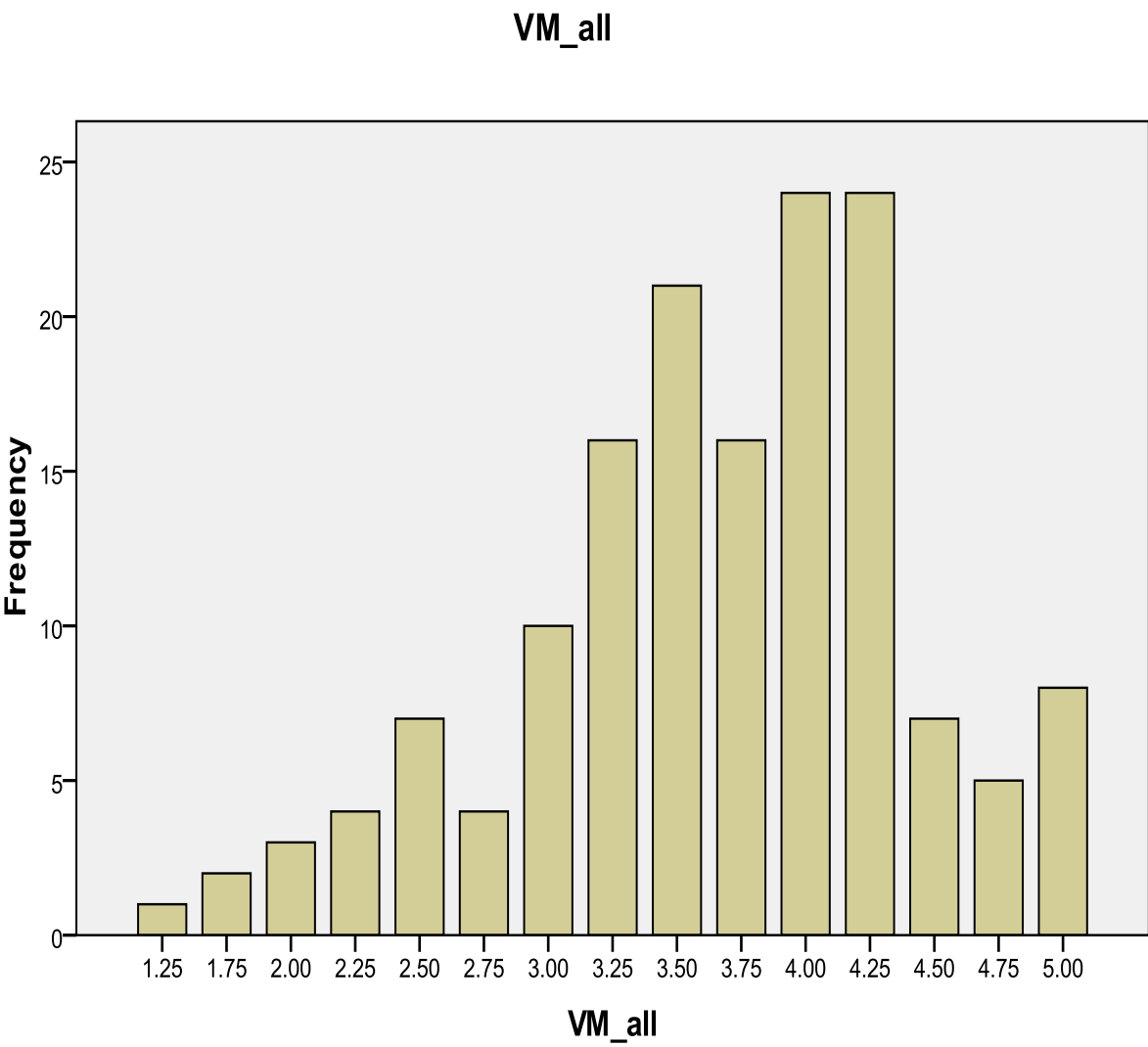
Social Media Marketing	strongly agree	agree	uncertain/ not applicable	disagree	strongly disagree
1. Social media provides opportunity to present view-point and agenda?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. I can openly express my opinions and judgements on online forums?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Propagating negative content regarding online restaurants on social media effects on business?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Social media marketing of content must not be carried out?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. The transformation of thoughts can prevail through social media promotional content?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Viral Marketing	strongly agree	agree	uncertain/ not applicable	disagree	strongly disagree
1. Viral feedback effects the purchase process?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. I listen to others while making purchase decisions?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

3. Taking feedback is essential before opting for online food purchasing?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Viral marketing on different forums does not effect on my purchase decisions at all?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours	strongly agree	agree	uncertain/ not applicable	disagree	strongly disagree
1. Online food ordering is relatively easy.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. I order food online when I see it.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. I prefer ordering for food online instead of physically going to the restaurants.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Online ads of restaurants have positive effects on me.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Descriptive Statistics Table: Social media marketing

Descriptive Statistics Table: Viral Marketing



Descriptive Statistics Table: Online Impulsive Buying Behaviours